

2016年9月公共英语三级真题

SECTION I Listening

(25 minutes)

Directions:

This section is designed to test your ability to understand spoken English. You will hear a selection of recorded materials and you must answer the questions that accompany them. There are two parts in this section, Part A and Part B.

Remember, while you are doing the test, you should first put down your answers in your test booklet. At the end of the listening comprehension section, you will have 3 minutes to transfer your answers from your test booklet onto your ANSWER SHEET.

If you have any questions, you may raise your hand now as you will not be allowed to speak once the test has started.

Now look at Part A in your test booklet.

Part A

Directions:

You will hear 10 short dialogues. For each dialogue, there is one question and four possible answers. Choose the correct answer A, B, C or D, and mark it in your test booklet. You will have 15 seconds to answer the question and you will hear each dialogue only once.

1. Where is George now?

[A] In America. [B] Here. [C] In France. [D] At home.

2. Where does this conversation probably take place?

[A] At a laundry. [B] At a supermarket.
[C] At a cafeteria. [D] At a movie theatre.

3. What does the man say about Tom?

[A] He has lost many of his paintings.
[B] He has become a good person.
[C] His fortune has been good recently.
[D] He doesn't make good painting any longer.

4. What is the woman going to do?

[A] To go to another store.
[B] To go to the second floor for the coat.
[C] To buy herself a new coat.
[D] To go up to the third floor for the coat.

5. How does the woman think of the man's value?
[A] Modern. [B] Traditional. [C] Old-fashioned. [D] Friendly.
6. Why does the woman want to keep the skirt?
[A] It fits her. [B] She likes it.
[C] It is a gift from the man. [D] It is cheap.
7. What does the woman mean?
[A] The fresh air in the country is helpful to health.
[B] People can only feel relaxed when in the country.
[C] She has no time to go to the country.
[D] She is not willing to spend the weekend in the country.
8. What does the woman suggest Jerry do?
[A] Find another place to live.
[B] Sell his apartment to someone else.
[C] Start looking for some place to live near the campus.
[D] Come back to the campus.
9. Why did the man wake up late this morning?
[A] Because he twisted his ankle the night before.
[B] Because the battery in his alarm clock had run out of electricity.
[C] Because his mother forgot to wake him up.
[D] Because he didn't hear the alarm clock.
10. What can we say about the man?
[A] It is the first time he has been in China.
[B] He likes China very much.
[C] He used to be a teacher in China.
[D] He is a young man.

Part B

Directions:

You will hear four dialogues or monologues. Before listening to each one, you will have 5 seconds to read each of the questions which accompany it. While listening, answer each question by choosing A, B, C or D. After listening, you will have 10 seconds to check your answer to each question. You will hear the recording only once.

Questions 11 - 13 are based on the following passage about the transportation in the future.

11. What will be used to power cars in the next few decades?
[A] Gas. [B] Electricity. [C] Solar energy. [D] Alcohol.

12. What will future news reports focus on when talking about transportation?

[A] Road conditions. [B] Highway traffic.

[C] Air traffic conditions. [D] New traffic rules.

13. What will passengers be asked to do when they travel to the moon?

[A] Carry little luggage.

[B] Go through a health check.

[C] Arrive 10 minutes earlier for boarding.

[D] Undergo security check.

Questions 14 - 17 are based on the following dialogue.

14. What is the main purpose of the man's trip?

[A] To improve his skating techniques. [B] To climb mountains.

[C] To take a vacation. [D] To learn to ski.

15. Why does the woman know so much about Albuquerque?

[A] Because her sister lives there.

[B] Because she attends college there.

[C] Because she lives thirty miles from there.

[D] Because she had the vacation there last year.

16. What may cause most problems in Albuquerque, in the woman's opinion?

[A] The cold weather. [B] The low humidity.

[C] The high altitude. [D] The changing climate.

17. What can be inferred about the man from the conversation?

[A] He has ever been to Albuquerque before.

[B] He has just graduated from college.

[C] He is going to New Mexico.

[D] He loves chess.

Questions 18-21 are based on the following dialogue between a doctor and his patient.

18. What's wrong with the woman?

[A] She hasn't recovered from her illness.

[B] She can't have a good sleep.

[C] She has a headache.

[D] She can't understand the doctor.

19. What advice did the doctor give the woman?

[A] To take as many tablets as possible.

[B] To rest as much as possible.

[C] To do as much housework as possible.

- [D] To lie in bed until she feels better.
20. What made it difficult for the woman to follow the man's advice?
- [A] She didn't want to lose her job.
[B] She had to do housework.
[C] She had to look after her children.
[D] Both B and C.
21. In what tone does the man talk to the woman?
- [A] Sympathetic. [B] Scornful. [C] Cold. [D] Firm.

Questions 22~25 are based on the following passage about prisoners and prisons in Britain.

22. In Britain, if a man commits some crime, what punishment will he probably get?
- [A] He will be hanged.
[B] He will be fined heavily.
[C] He will be sent to an open prison.
[D] He will be ordered to do some community work.
23. What do we know about women prisoners in Britain?
- [A] Most of them are very young.
[B] They are kept in closed prisons.
[C] They don't have freedom in prison.
[D] They are a small portion of the prison population.
24. In what way are open prisons different from closed prisons?
- [A] They have a longer history.
[B] All of their prisoners are expected to work.
[C] Their prisoners can visit their families and friends.
[D] Some of their prisoners are allowed to study or work outside prisons.
25. What do we learn about prisoners in Britain from the passage?
- [A] They live a comfortable life in prisons.
[B] Most of them get paid for their work.
[C] They have to cook their own meals.
[D] They are locked up most of the time.

You now have 3 minutes to transfer all your answers from your test booklet to your ANSWER SHEET.

That is the end of listening section.

SECTION II Reading

(50 minutes)

Part A

Directions:

Read the following two texts. Answer the questions on each text by choosing A, B, C or D. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

Text 1

Late last year, I needed to transport some furniture from our house in Sussex to my son's flat in central London. I should have paid a man to do it for me, but foolishly confident in my driving ability, I decided to hire a van and drive it myself. It was a Ford Transit 280, long and wide; you couldn't see out of the back. You never really knew how close you were to anything else on the road.

Reversing in my home yard, I crashed into a small shed, causing permanent damage. At least I owned the shed.

I loaded up the furniture and set out. By now it was rush hour. My nerves broke down, as I steered the huge van through ever-shifting lanes, across oncoming vehicles, between distances of buses, at last to Charlotte Street.

Here, I found an available parking space. As I reversed into it, I noticed three people at a pavement cafe waving to me. I got out, trembling violently, like one who has just endured a stormy Atlantic crossing. "You've shifted the car parked behind you three feet," they said, and it belonged to a disabled person. I examined the car. There were white scratches along its front bumper. It bore a disabled sign. So, now I was a bad driver and a bad man. Under the stem gaze of the three, I left an apologetic note on the damaged car's windscreen, giving my phone number.

I unloaded the furniture, dripping with sweat. Wanting only to escape the monster, I drove the van back to its base on the Edgware Road. On arrival, the hire man told me I must fill it up with petrol before returning it. "Just charge me," I cried, still shaking with fear. He gazed at me with understanding. No doubt he'd witnessed others in this state before. "How about I drive you to a petrol station, you fill up, and I drive her back?" he asked.

He danced the great van through the traffic so casually that it would have shamed me if I had not been so grateful.

26. The writer felt regretful that he had_____.

- [A] hired someone to drive for him [B] asked his son to do the delivery
[C] rented a small van for his goods [D] delivered the furniture himself

27. On his way to Charlotte Street, the writer felt _____.

[A] frightened [B] annoyed [C] relaxed [D] excited

28. In the parking lot, the writer _____ .

[A] saw a disabled man [B] ran into his friends

[C] hit another vehicle [D] examined his van

29. The writer uses the word "monster" (para. 5) to refer to _____ .

[A] the bad experience [B] the heavy furniture

[C] the guy at the base [D] the vehicle he drove

30. Watching the hire man drive, the writer felt _____.

[A] doubtful [B] grateful [C] ashamed [D] worried

Text 2

By the time you retire, there's no doubt about it, your brain isn't what it used to be. By 65, most people will start to notice the signs: you forget people's names and the teapot occasionally turns up in the fridge.

There is a good reason why our memories start to let us down. At this stage of life, we are steadily losing brain cells in critical areas. This is not too much of a problem at first; even in old age, the brain is flexible enough to compensate. At some point, though, the losses start to make themselves felt.

Clearly, not everyone ages in the same way, so what's the difference between a happy, intelligent old person and a forgetful, bad-tempered granny? And can we improve our chances of becoming the former?

Exercise can certainly help. Numerous studies have shown that gentle exercise three times a week can improve concentration and abstract reasoning in older people, perhaps by encouraging the growth of new brain cells. Exercise also helps steady our blood sugar. As we age, our blood sugar control worsens, which causes a large increase in blood sugar levels. This can affect an area that helps form memories. Since physical activity helps control blood sugar, getting out and about could reduce these peaks and, potentially, improve your memory.

Coordination training could also help. Studies have shown that specifically targeting motor control and balance improves learning function in 60 to 80-year-olds.

"Brain training", was once considered strange, but a study concludes that computerised brain exercises can improve memory and attention in the over 65s. Importantly, these changes were large enough that participants reported significant improvements in everyday activities, such as remembering names or following conversations in noisy restaurants.

Avoiding the complaints is even easier. In fact, your brain is doing all it can to ensure a contented retirement. By 65, we are much better at increasing the experience of positive emotion, says Florin Dolcos, a neurobiologist at the University of Alberta in Canada. In experiments, he

found that people over the age of 60 tended to remember fewer emotionally negative photographs compared with positive ones than younger people.

31. It is usual for retired people to have _____ .

[A] a distant memory

[B] a terrible memory

[C] a painful memory

[D] a changeable memory

32. According to the text, mild exercise helps old people

[A] avoid a bad temper

[B] feel happy with their life

[C] practise creative thinking

[D] improve their mental ability

33. It is learned from the text that high blood sugar may _____ .

[A] encourage brain cells to grow

[B] result in poor concentration

[C] affect physical activity

[D] lead to memory loss

34. Through “brain training,” old people can _____ .

[A] improve their physical balance

[B] cope better with daily activities

[C] cooperate better with each other

[D] become skillful at using computers

35. According to Florin Dolcos, when it comes to retirement, most old people tend to feel

[A] satisfied

[B] depressed

[C] hopeful

[D] regretful

Part B

Directions:

Read the texts from a magazine article in which five people talked about advertisements aimed at children. For questions 36-40, match the name of each person to one of the statements(A-G) given below. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

Anne:

I really don't think that it's moral to target children with advertisements, as they are not yet able to distinguish advertising from actual programming in the way adults can. This means that advertising aimed at children is misleading and unfair. It is also clearly effective, as otherwise advertisers would not spend hundreds of millions of dollars each year targeting children who are not yet able to resist their sales pitch.

John:

Advertising aimed at children brings negative social consequences, as much of it is for food and drinks that are unhealthy. Encouraging naive children to consume so much fatty, sugary and salty food is morally wrong because it creates overweight, unhealthy youngsters, with bad eating

habits that will be with them for life. Society may pay a high price in terms of the extra medical care such children will eventually require.

Lily:

I think banning advertisements is a severe restriction upon freedom of speech. Companies should be able to tell the public about any legal products, or innovation will be restricted and new companies will find it hard to market their products successfully in the face of established rivals. Children also have a human right to receive information from a wide range of sources and make up their own minds about it.

Ross:

Children naturally like foods that are rich in fats and sugar. They give them the energy they need to play energetically and grow healthily. It is true that eating only such foods is bad for people, but this is a problem of bad parenting rather than the fault of advertising. If advertising to children were banned, then governments would not be able to use this means of promoting healthy eating.

Julia:

Children are not naive innocents, but clever consumers who can distinguish at a very young age between advertisements and programs and understand that advertisements can be misleading. This essential learning process is, in fact, developed through exposure to advertisements. It is also assisted by responsible parenting that does not just leave children alone in front of the television, but spends some time watching with them and discussing what is seen.

Now match the name of each person (36-40) to the appropriate statement.

Note-there are two extra statements.

Statements

- | | |
|-----------|--|
| 36. Anne | [A] Parents' bad lifestyle influences their children. |
| 37. John | [B] It's not right to ban advertisements. |
| 38. Lily | [C] Don't blame advertisements for kids' bad eating habits. |
| 39. Ross | [D] Children are easily misled by advertisements. |
| 40. Julia | [E] Watching TV advertisements is a process of learning for kids. |
| | [F] It's time to ban advertisements aimed at children. |
| | [G] Advertisements aimed at children may bring trouble to society. |

Part C

Directions:

Read the following text from which five sentences have been removed. Choose from the sentences A - G the most suitable one to fill each numbered gap in the text (41 — 45). There are two extra sentences that you do not need to use. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

Entrepreneurs and small business owners are typically buried in demands and obligations.

So, learning to say "no" and focus on the right things is critically important.

Vickie Milazzo, a very successful businessman and author of *Wicked Success Is Inside Every Woman*, has some useful advice that could certainly benefit just about anyone, not just women.

Use your time wisely. 41 You have to work hard at them every day, sometimes in very small steps, so you should commit to doing something every day toward your goal and reach it in separate but related stages.

Abandon perfectionism. When you get there, success may not look like what you expected. 42 You all have your own idea of how success will look and feel when you get there, so your ability to be flexible and adjust your goals could get you to a place of success much earlier than you otherwise might.

43 If you are struggling to achieve a goal, you cannot learn much from someone else who is struggling to achieve that same goal. Therefore, you should look around for other people who have achieved what you want. In other words, you should find those whose work you admire and model yourself after them.

Keep it fresh. 44 Tap back into the frame of mind you had when you were just starting out. Finding that passion again will often renew your energy and engagement.

Finally, give yourself a break. If you stepped back and looked at your daily routine objectively, as if it were happening to your best friend, what would your advice be? Would it be: Slow down? 45 Or spend a few moments enjoying the day?

[A] More haste, less speed.

[B] Hang on to your dreams.

[C] Take a few deep breaths?

[D] Do you remember why you wanted the career you have?

[E] You cannot achieve big goals overnight.

[F] Find successful people to learn from and imitate.

[G] So, you should adjust your expectations and definition of success along the way.

Part D

Directions:

Read the following text from which 10 words have been removed. Choose from the words A - O the most suitable one to fill each numbered gap in the text (46 - 55). There are five extra words that you do not need to use. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

When I tell people that I work from wherever I want, whether it be home or a friend's office, I am generally met with a bit of scorn or a response that points out how "lucky" I am. Actually, I'm just getting to 46 what millions of people are already living: the mobile office.

Office space has undergone marked changes in the past few decades, with wooden desks being 47 by customizable cubicle walls and desks, then shifting to many of the new open-office designs we see now. This evolution is continuing as 48 realize that mobile technology is keeping workers away from the office more than ever.

Perhaps the most 49 change this year is something that has already begun. Thanks to increasing 50 on mobile devices, professionals can make a seamless transition from home to meetings to the office, with clients and 51 never realizing the change in location. Phones can easily be routed to cell phones, and cloud-based file storage means documents can be 52 from any device with an Internet connection.

As the “work anywhere” trend continues to grow, professionals will have more 53 than ever. They’ ll no longer be chained to a desk eight hours a day, allowing them to be more 54 and more reachable when they’ re needed. In time, this will most likely 55 the definition of the office to include any location where an Internet connection is available.

- | | | |
|-----------------|----------------|----------------|
| [A] accessed | [B] businesses | [C] confidence |
| [D] considerate | [E] created | [F] customers |
| [G] efficient | [H] engineers | [I] experience |
| [J] freedom | [K] notable | [L] provide |
| [M] reliance | [N] replaced | [O] reshape |

SECTION III Writing

(45 minutes)

Directions:

You should write your responses to both Part A and Part B of this section on your ANSWERSHEET.

Part A

56.

A local environmental group is recruiting volunteers at the moment. You are willing to become one of them. Write an email to the recruiters, telling them:

- 1) why you want to be a volunteer;
- 2) what you can do for the group ;
- 3) when you will be available.

You should write about 100 words. Do not sign your own name at the end of your email. Use “Wang Lin “instead.

Part B

57.

Directions:

Read the text below. Write an essay in about 120 words, in which you should summarize the key points of the text and make comments on them. Try to use your own words.

A millionaire in New York suffered from a severe eye disease. He got a famous doctor to treat his eye. The doctor performed a minor operation on the millionaire, gave him some medicine and advised him to avoid bright light for one month so as to add to the treatment and ensure speedy recovery. On arriving home, the millionaire immediately acted on the doctor's advice. He closed all his windows, replaced the colorful curtains with dark heavy ones, removed his bright ceiling lights and used dim bulbs. In a word, he went to great lengths to make his house completely dark.

Two weeks later, the doctor paid a visit to the millionaire to enquire about his recovery. To the doctor's astonishment, everything in the house was made dark and dull. "Just look at all this," said the millionaire proudly. "Not the lowest beam of light inside. I spent \$5,000 on the changes to the house. I followed your advice faithfully. " "You sure did," replied the doctor, but

he found it hard to say that it was a matter of plain common sense that the millionaire could have bought a pair of sunglasses, which would cost much less, rather than spending so much money making the house darker, in order to avoid bright light.

THAT IS THE END OF THE TEST.